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Teacher name

Cart 315

The second chapter of “The Stuff Games Are Made Of” by Pippin Bar explores how change comes from within games. Our main topic for chapter two is Pong and how the core game mechanics can change while the game's essence remains.

As I read chapter two, I noticed how Pippin says “the original Pong is simplicity itself” (Bar, 2023). With resources limited at the time, Pong became a simple game that required no interaction beyond moving the paddles up and down while trying to block the ball from entering the goal; it's as simple as it can get. However, now that our technology has had a major upgrade, old games such as Pong have become more accessible for customization: “Pong's rules are made of code. And code can be rewritten” (Bar, 2023), and that's what I think is meaningful in chapter two: how Pippin explores the game and the code itself. He changes one thing about the game, and it creates a whole new way of playing; however, it never changes the essence of how Pong was supposed to be played. This is similar to today's modding scene, where various modders can change how the game looks and, at times, change how a player plays the game, but it can never change the essence of said game. I believe Pippin wanted to see how the variations of Pong affected the player. “This experiment is designed by me, but then it is carried out by you in play, and you must draw your own

conclusions from the results.” (Bar,2023) It’s a reflection of our own experience; every new iteration doesn’t only question why he’s done this, but also how the gameplay changes with each iteration. It’s to see how far the changes can go before the game becomes something entirely new.